Seeing Through Photographs
Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to Seeing Through Photographs

Module 2
One Subject, Many Perspectives
Part I: Introduction
- Introduction to Module 1
  Reading • 2 min
- Artistic Equivalents
  Reading • 2 min
- Vik Muniz on Photographing the Familiar
  Video • 3 min

Part II: Telescopes and Cameras
- Introduction to Part II: Surface, Scale, and Technology
  Video • 2 min
- Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- Moons and Surfaces
  Reading • 5 min
- Hear More: Sarah Meister on Eugène Atget. Pendant l'éclipse. 1912
  Video • 3 min
- Hear More: Liz Deschenes on Tilt/Swing (360° field of vision, version 1), 2009
  Video • 1 min
- Surface, Scale, Technology
  Dialogue • 15 min

Part III: Seeing the Unseen
- Introduction to Part III: Man on the Moon
  Video • 2 min
- Photographs by NASA
  Reading • 2 min
- Hear More: Sarah Meister on U.S.G.S. and NASA, Surveyor III. Surface of the Moon, Day 319, W-F. 1967
  Video • 1 min
- Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- Who Does the Moon Belong To?
  Reading • 4 min

Part IV: It's Only a Paper Moon
- Introduction to Part IV: Vernacular and Fine Art Photographs of the Moon
  Video • 3 min
- Moon Phases
  Reading • 6 min
- Hear More: Sarah Meister on Ansel Adams. Moonrise, Hernandez, New Mexico. 1941
  Video • 3 min
- Man on the Moon and Paper Moons
  Dialogue • 15 min

Part V: Review and Respond
- Optional Readings and Resources
  Reading • 10 min
- Practice Memory Check
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%
- Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
  Reading • 10 min

Module 3
Documents and the Documentary
Part I: Introduction
- Introduction to Module 3
  Reading • 2 min
- Sarah Meister on Documents and the Documentary
  Video • 3 min

Part II: Framing Reality
- Facts and Fictions
  Reading • 6 min
- Fictions and Facts
  Reading • 6 min
- Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- Hear More: Mike Mandel on Evidence, 1977
  Video • 4 min
- Hear More: Thomas Demand on Room (Zimmer), 1996
  Video • 1 min

Part III: Words and Pictures
- Artist Spotlight: Dorothea Lange
  Reading • 4 min
- Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- Hear More: Sarah Meister on Dorothea Lange. Migrant Mother. 1936
  Video • 2 min
- Hear More: Sarah Meister on Dorothea Lange. On the Road to Los Angeles, California. March 1937
  Video • 1 min
- Artist Spotlight: Gordon Parks
  Reading • 4 min

Part IV: Focus on New Documents, 1967
- Introduction to Part IV: Sarah Meister on New Documents
  Video • 3 min
- New Documents: Arbus, Friedlander, and Winogrand
  Reading • 4 min

Part V: Review and Respond
- Practice Memory Check
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%
- Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
  Reading • 10 min
- Optional Readings and Resources
  Reading • 10 min

Module 4
One and Another
Part I: Introduction
- Introduction to Module 4
  Reading • 2 min
- Sarah Meister on Photography and Multiplicity
  Video • 2 min

Part II: Albums and Books
- Artwork Spotlight: Frances Benjamin Johnston's The Hampton Album, 1899-1900
  Reading • 2 min
- Hear More: Sarah Meister on Frances Benjamin Johnston. The Hampton Album. 1899-1900
  Video • 1 min
- Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- Photo Books
  Reading • 8 min

Part III: Bodies of Work
- **Photo Series**
  Reading • 13 min
- Hear More: Nicholas Nixon on The Brown Sisters, 1975–2022
  Video • 1 min
- Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- Hear More: Sohrab Hura on Snow, 2015–ongoing
  Video • 5 min

Part IV: One from Many
- One from Many
  Reading • 8 min
- Hear More: Irina Rozovsky on Miracle Center, 2019–ongoing
  Video • 5 min

Part V: Review and Respond
- Practice Memory Check
  Practice Assignment • 30 min
- Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
  Reading • 10 min
- Optional Readings and Resources
  Reading • 10 min
- Optional Mid-Course Survey
  Reading • 5 min

Module 5
Constructing Narratives, Challenging Histories

Module 6
Pictures of People

Module 7
Ocean of Images

Photo Series

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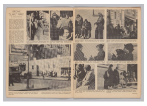
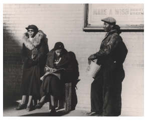
Robert H. McNeill



Spread from "The Bronx Slave Market." *Flash Weekly Newspicture Magazine*. February 14, 1938. Ink on paper, 11 7/8 x 8 7/8" (30.2 x 22.5 cm) overall. Collection of the Smithsonian National Museum of African American History and Culture. Gift from Charles A. Harris and Beatrice Harris in memory of Charles "Teenie" Harris. Photo courtesy the Smithsonian National Museum of African American History and Culture

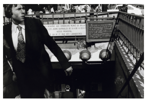


Robert H. McNeill. *Make a wish*. 1937. Gelatin silver print, 6 3/4 × 8 11/16" (17.1 × 22 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Acquired through the generosity of The Friends of Education of The Museum of Modern Art and Committee on Photography Fund. © 2020 Heirs of Robert H. McNeill

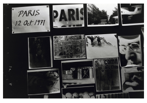
At the age of twenty, Robert McNeill moved to New York to study photography. There, he received a tip that *Fortune* magazine was looking for photographs of domestic workers and he began a series of images anchored by an intersection in the Bronx where Black men and women would gather to negotiate day jobs with potential white employers. Though *Fortune* ultimately rejected the pictures, they were picked up by *Flash!*, a Black-published magazine based out of Washington, D.C. Thirteen of McNeill's images appeared in the February 14, 1938 issue, including this one. One woman studies a newspaper, while the other two figures look hopefully toward the street, unintentionally embodying the message from the movie poster above the man's head: "MAKE A WISH."

The setting for this series was the intersection of 170th Street between Jerome and Walton Avenues, known as the Bronx Slave Market. McNeill later recalled, "The idea that this woman had come up from the South, maybe was staying with relatives in New York and needed to help pay the rent, and ended up doing what she had known in the South. Or the expression on the white woman's face, after she offers to pay 15 cents [an hour] and [the potential employee] says, 'Uh-uh, 20 cents is my price.' I guess the pictures were too strong for *Fortune*, though, because they were never used."

Takuma Nakahira



Takuma Nakahira. *C-177* from the series Circulation: Date, Place, Events. 1971. Gelatin silver print, printed 2013, 12 5/8 × 18 7/8" (32.1 × 48 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. David H. McAlpin Fund. © 2020 Takuma Nakahira. Courtesy Yossi Milo Gallery

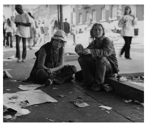


Takuma Nakahira. *C-094* from the series Circulation: Date, Place, Events. 1971. Gelatin silver print, printed 2013, 12 5/8 × 18 7/8" (32.1 × 48 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. David H. McAlpin Fund. © 2020 Takuma Nakahira. Courtesy Yossi Milo Gallery

Invited to participate in the Seventh Paris Biennale, Takuma Nakahira arrived in the city several days late. Instead of displaying photographs of Japan, as the exhibition's curators had requested, Nakahira contributed a group of photographs accumulated over the course of seven days in Paris. Describing his process, the artist states, "I set myself to photograph, develop, and exhibit nothing but the Paris that I was living and experiencing."

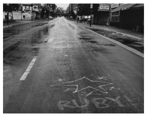
After exposing multiple rolls of film over the course of a day, he would immediately develop them, make prints of the images, and tack them up for display that same evening, often still wet. The next day he would begin again so that the resulting series, Circulation: Date, Place, Events, became the product of a daily routine. For Nakahira, these photographs were the "mere remnants" of his process, which consisted of his own circulation around the city as well as the circulation of images, from darkroom to display.

Richard Misrach



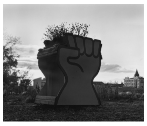
Richard Misrach. *Mono and friend*. 1972–74. Gelatin silver print, 9 5/8 × 11 7/16" (24.4 × 29 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Acquired through the generosity of Robert Harteveldt. © 2020 Richard Misrach

In his 1974 photo book *Telegraph 3 A.M.*, Misrach recounts the project's origins in a prophetic dream: "I took the dream as a mandate to photograph the faces I had seen, which I recognized as the street people of Telegraph Avenue." Misrach followed this call, capturing the often homeless inhabitants of the major thoroughfare he traversed daily on his way to work at the University of California campus in Berkeley.



Richard Misrach. *Untitled* from the series Telegraph 3 A.M. 1972–74. Gelatin silver print, 9 1/4 × 11 5/8" (23.5 × 29.5 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Acquired through the generosity of Robert Harteveldt. © 2020 Richard Misrach

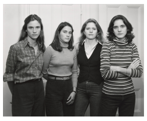
Here, the name Ruby emblazoned on the street calls forward the many faces and lives he encountered while creating this series. Depicting the struggles of displaced young people, Telegraph 3 A.M. exposes the suffering and disillusionment that followed the romantic ideals of the 1960s counterculture movement.



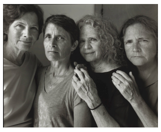
Richard Misrach. *Untitled* from the series Telegraph 3 A.M. 1972–74. Gelatin silver print, 9 7/8 × 11 3/4" (23.5 × 29.5 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Acquired through the generosity of Robert Harteveldt. © 2020 Richard Misrach

A block of land just off Telegraph Avenue was purchased by UC Berkeley in 1967. When it remained undeveloped for a period of time, community members seized the land, transforming it into People's Park. It was a site of gathering for members of the Black Panther Party and the free speech movement, as well as an encampment for many homeless youth. In this photograph, flowers and plants sprout from the raised fist. This depiction of growth and resilience, paired with a symbol of solidarity and strength for several human rights movements, illustrates the park's role as a sanctuary for many people. Today, People's Park faces significant change as UC Berkeley constructs student housing on its grounds.

Nicholas Nixon



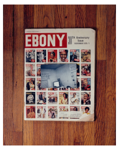
Nicholas Nixon. *The Brown Sisters, Cambridge, Massachusetts*. 1977. Gelatin silver print, 7 11/16 × 9 11/16" (19.6 × 24.6 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. John Parkinson III Fund. © 2020 Nicholas Nixon



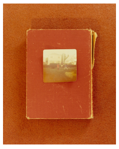
Nicholas Nixon. *The Brown Sisters, Truro, Massachusetts*. 2016. Gelatin silver print, 16 × 20" (40.6 × 50.8 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. John Szarkowski Fund. © 2016 Nicholas Nixon

In 1975, Nicholas Nixon began photographing his wife, Bebe, and her three sisters, Mimi, Laurie, and Heather, for what has become a series called The Brown Sisters. Nixon always uses an 8 x 10 inch view camera on a tripod to take a handful of exposures, each one captured on a black-and-white-film negative. From these exposures he and his subjects confer to select the final portrait. Although the sisters always appear in the same order year after year, the passage of time marks these intimate portraits of the photographer's family.

Leslie Hewitt



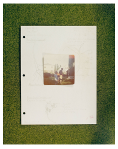
Leslie Hewitt. *Riffs on Real Time*. 2002–05. Chromogenic color print, 30 × 24" (76.2 × 61 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Fund for the Twenty-First Century. © 2020 Leslie Hewitt



Leslie Hewitt. *Riffs on Real Time*. 2002–05. Chromogenic color print, 30 × 24" (76.2 × 61 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Fund for the Twenty-First Century. © 2020 Leslie Hewitt

For her series Riffs on Real Time, Hewitt repurposed domestic and personal objects such as family snapshots, books, magazines, and handwritten letters to create still lifes that intertwine personal and historical narratives. Each photograph pictures three elements: a personal snapshot, a piece of historical or recent ephemera, and a highly textured colored backdrop meant to evoke textures and colors from domestic environments from an unspecified, but instantly recognizable era.

The works are meticulously composed, revealing Hewitt's sculptural approach to image making. The play of meaning between the items in her photographs is sometimes deeply personal and other times more broadly political, often questioning the nostalgia that is evoked through family mementos and relics of the civil rights era. In her own words, this process of layering and photographing allows Hewitt to "explore the limits of a single photograph, a single perspective."



Leslie Hewitt. *Riffs on Real Time*. 2002–05. Chromogenic color print, 30 × 24" (76.2 × 61 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Fund for the Twenty-First Century. © 2020 Leslie Hewitt

Coming of age during a time where disposable cameras made photographs easier to produce, Riffs on Real Time reflects Hewitt's fascination with the tangible nature of pictures. "A photograph, or at least an analog photograph, is always about the past," she states. "It stops time momentarily and then we appreciate it [that moment] from the present tense looking back. I have always found this attribute of the photographic experience intriguing and important to how we perceive time."

Aïda Muluneh